CERNO GLOBUS

FIELD INTELLIGENCE

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Professional Services

Property Management · Independent Practices · Independent Agencies · Small Accounting Practices · Staffing Agencies · Brokerages and Agent Teams

Six trades, one publication. Every item is something that moves a number on your P&L, changes what you must do by law, or changes what parts and labor cost you.

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Read it online
This issue, and every one before it

RULE

AICPA's ethics committee voted to publish a revised exposure draft on private-equity-backed firm structures, with 120 days for comment and a one-year runway after adoption, reported November 3.

AICPA's Professional Ethics Executive Committee voted in early November to publish a revised exposure draft changing the Code of Professional Conduct for alternative practice structures, including those with private-equity investment. The draft was expected online later in November, with a 120-day comment period.

It responds to 81 comment letters on the December 2025 proposal. The code has had alternative-practice-structure provisions since 2000; rising private-equity investment prompted the committee to clarify independence and conflict-of-interest rules.

Under current guidance and state law, attest firms must have at least majority CPA ownership. The new draft treats the attest firm, a closely aligned entity and that entity's controlling investor as network firms, and adds the entity's CEO to covered members.

It also bars attest services to businesses over which the investor has significant influence, where the earlier draft relied on case-by-case evaluation. If adopted in 2027, the changes take effect one year later, and firms may adopt earlier.

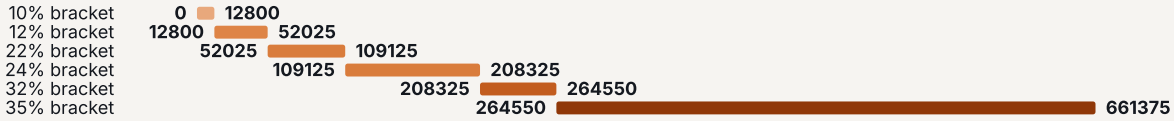
What to do about it: If an outside investor has bought into your firm or is in talks, list every attest client and every business the investor can influence, and ask counsel to read the draft the day it posts. Do not sign term sheets with independence terms until you have compared them with the draft's network-firm definition. If you are a conventional firm with no investor, note that the draft excludes you but existing independence rules still apply. Put the 120-day comment window on your calendar and decide whether your state society will file a comment. Tell partners in writing what the one-year runway means for any deal that closes in 2027.

JofA: AICPA proposes ethics guidance for APS

INFOGRAPHIC 1 / 2027 TAX BRACKETS

For single filers in 2027, the 22% bracket starts at $52,025 and the 32% bracket at $208,325.

Taxable-income band for each rate, single filers, tax year 2027, dollars. IRS Rev. Proc. 2026-35 as reported by the Journal of Accountancy, November 5, 2026.



Each band runs from the rate's starting threshold to the next one; the 35% band ends where the 37% rate begins at $661,375. Joint filers' thresholds through the 35% rate are exactly double the single-filer figures. For an owner whose pass-through income sits near $109,125 or $208,325, those are the lines where the next dollar is taxed at a higher rate. Run client projections on the 2027 numbers. Update your 2027 withholding and estimated-payment worksheets before client meetings begin. JofA: IRS announces 2027 inflation adjustments

PROPERTY MANAGEMENT

TWO ITEMS

DEMAND

Apartment List's October 28 report puts national median rent at $1,384, down 0.3% on the month and up 0.1% on the year, with 45 of 55 large metros lower.

Why it matters: The November report, released October 28, has national median rent at $1,384, up 0.1% from a year ago. The vacancy index is 7.0%, down from a 7.3% peak in February. Forty-five of 55 large metros saw rents fall in the month and 35 of 55 were higher on the year. San Antonio was down 3.8% on the year, the largest decline among large metros, while the San Francisco metro was up 13%. Compare your own October renewal and new-lease rents with your submarket before you set 2027 renewal offers.

Apartment List National Rent Report, Nov 2026

REGULATION

Illinois's rental fee law, signed at the end of June 2026, applies to leases entered into after January 1, 2027, capping application fees at $50 (higher only for actual third-party screening cost) and banning fees for renewals and after-hours repairs.

Why it matters: Public Act 104-0479 requires every non-optional fee to appear on the first page of the lease; a tenant owes no fee that is missing there. Application fees over $50 are allowed only where the actual third-party screening cost is higher. Fees for lease renewals, after-hours maintenance requests, move-in walk-throughs and pre-order eviction notices are banned, and renaming a fee does not avoid the rule. Owner-occupied premises with six or fewer units are exempt. Any person alleging a violation may sue for injunctive relief, money and attorney's fees. Move every fee onto page one of your Illinois lease forms before January 1.

Illinois Public Act 104-0479 · Chicago Realtors: HB 3564 signed into law

INDEPENDENT PRACTICES

TWO ITEMS

MONEY

CMS replaced the G2211 add-on code with modifiers that raise payment for the base office visit 16%, or 32% for clinicians in the Shared Savings Program or LEAD Model, from January 1.

Why it matters: In the CY 2027 final rule released November 4, modifier B1 replaces G2211 and raises payment for the associated office visit by a flat 16%. Modifier B2 raises it 32% for clinicians in the Medicare Shared Savings Program or the LEAD Model. Ask your billing vendor when B1 and B2 will load in your claim system, and check whether any ACO contract you hold qualifies you for B2 before January 1.

AHA: CY 2027 physician fee schedule final rule · Medical Economics: advocates urge Congress to act · ACC: final 2027 physician fee schedule and OPPS rules

REGULATION

The final rule ends traditional MIPS with the 2031 performance period, two years later than proposed, adds MVPs for diabetes, hypertension and hospitalists, and requires a specialty core measure from 2027.

Why it matters: HHS's November 4 release says clinicians have through the 2030 performance period to move to MIPS Value Pathways or advanced APMs, and that MVPs already cover about 98% of clinicians. Starting in 2027, clinicians must report at least one specialty-specific core measure. Three new MVPs cover diabetes, hypertension and hospitalists. The transition period is two years longer than CMS proposed. Check which MVP fits your specialty, confirm the 2027 core measure appears in your EHR quality report, and enter the 2031 end date in your multi-year quality plan.

HHS: CMS finalizes 2027 Medicare physician fee schedule · AHA: CY 2027 physician fee schedule final rule

INFOGRAPHIC 2 / TRUEBLUE SEGMENTS

TrueBlue's PeopleReady revenue rose $86.6 million in the third quarter while its other two segments were nearly flat.

Segment revenue, $ millions; each bar runs from the third quarter of 2025 to the third quarter of 2026, 13 weeks ended September 27. TrueBlue release, November 4, 2026.



PeopleReady, TrueBlue's on-demand industrial staffing segment, added $86.6 million of revenue year over year. PeopleManagement added $2.5 million and PeopleSolutions $0.4 million. Company gross margin fell to about 20.5% from 22.7%, calculated from the release. Growth concentrated in one segment is the pattern to test in your own book. TrueBlue reports third quarter 2026 results

INDEPENDENT AGENCIES

TWO ITEMS

MONEY

Brown & Brown's third-quarter organic revenue grew 1.2%, against 3.5% a year earlier, and nine-month organic growth was 0.3% against 4.6%, Insurance Business reported October 27.

Why it matters: Brown & Brown's quarter ended September 30. Organic revenue rose 1.2%, or 1.5% with contingent commissions, after a 0.7% decline in the second quarter. Total revenue rose 7.4% to $1.7 billion, mainly from acquisitions. Adjusted EBITDAC margin fell to 34.6% from 36.6%. Management cited pricing pressure in catastrophe property and casualty lines. Pull your 2026 commission by line against 2025, split rate from new business, and set 2027 new-business targets by line.

Insurance Business: Brown & Brown organic growth 1.2% · Brown & Brown Q3 2026 results (via Quiver Quant)

INSURANCE

California's FAIR Plan added 2,200 policies from July to September, its slowest growth since 2022, as 12 homeowners insurers committed to stay and grow and the commissioner race stayed undecided.

Why it matters: The state insurance department reported October 29 that FAIR Plan growth slowed, and twelve insurers, including seven of the state's ten largest, committed to staying and growing in California. Insurance Business reported November 4 that rate filings under review are at their lowest in decades. Jane Kim led state Sen. Ben Allen narrowly in incomplete returns for commissioner; Kim would move wildfire coverage into a public program. A brokers' group says many insurers may be waiting on the result. If you place California homeowners, ask each carrier in writing for its 2027 appetite and filing status.

Insurance Business: California brokers warn of uncertainty

SMALL ACCOUNTING PRACTICES

TWO ITEMS

MONEY

The IRS reminded paid preparers on November 4 that PTINs expire December 31 and must be renewed for 2027 at a nonrefundable $18.75 each.

Why it matters: IR-2026-130 (November 4) says anyone paid to prepare federal returns needs a 2027 PTIN, and current numbers expire December 31, 2026. Online renewal takes about 15 minutes; a paper Form W-12 takes about six weeks. The fee is $18.75, or $187.50 for ten preparers. Renew every preparer on staff online this week and file the receipts.

IRS IR-2026-130: renew PTINs for 2027 · IRS e-News for Tax Professionals 2026-43

REGULATION

The IRS announced November 6 that authorized tax professionals can now make certain payments for business clients through the Tax Pro Account, including federal tax deposits.

Why it matters: Before the change, professionals could view business clients' balances and payment activity but could not submit payments. Covered payments are full or partial balances due, amended returns, proposed assessments and federal tax deposits. The professional needs authorization for both the client and the tax matter. Earlier in 2026 the IRS added business-level Centralized Authorization File tools. Check your firm's authorizations on file for business clients before you offer to make payments for them.

JofA: IRS expands Tax Pro Account for business payments

STAFFING AGENCIES

TWO ITEMS

LABOR

Temporary help services added 18,600 jobs in October, BLS reported November 6, and revisions turned September from a loss of 10,900 to a loss of 5,600.

Why it matters: The November 6 release also revised August from a gain of 200 to a gain of 15,500, and the October 2 release had September at a loss of 10,900. The series is now -10,000 in July, +15,500 in August, -5,600 in September and +18,600 in October. Any client or lender deck that still quotes the September drop of 10,900 is out of date. Replace it with the revised figures, and refresh your own hiring-demand forecast on all four months.

BLS Employment Situation, October 2026 · BLS Employment Situation, September 2026

DEMAND

TrueBlue's third-quarter revenue rose 20.7% to $520.7 million as PeopleReady jumped to $338.0 million, while gross margin fell to 20.5% from 22.7%.

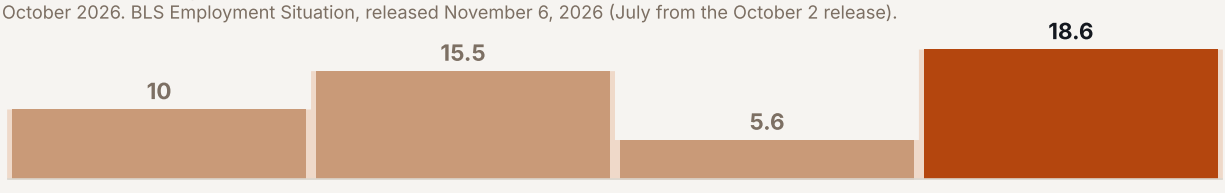
Why it matters: TrueBlue reported November 4 that revenue was $520.7 million against $431.3 million, with PeopleReady up from $251.4 million to $338.0 million and the other two segments nearly flat. Gross profit was $107.0 million against $97.9 million, a 20.5% margin against 22.7%, calculated from the release. Adjusted EBITDA was $20.7 million, 4.0% of revenue, against $10.6 million, 2.5%. Net income was $9.2 million against a $1.9 million loss. Compare your gross margin on industrial placements with last year, client by client, before you take more volume at lower bill rates.

TrueBlue reports third quarter 2026 results · SIA: reluctant improvement seen for staffing industry

INFOGRAPHIC 3 / TEMP HELP MONTHLY CHANGE

Temporary help swung from a 10,000-job loss in July to an 18,600-job gain in October, with August and September revised.

Over-the-month change in temporary help services employment, seasonally adjusted, thousands of jobs, direction in label, July to October 2026. BLS Employment Situation, released November 6, 2026 (July from the October 2 release).



August now reads +15,500, not the +200 reported October 2, and September reads -5,600, not -10,900. October's 18,600 is the largest monthly gain of the four. Two of the four months are losses. Plan on the swing, not on the last print. BLS Employment Situation, October 2026

BROKERAGES AND AGENT TEAMS

TWO ITEMS

REGULATION

Seven MLSs now sue Compass in New York federal court after MLSListings joined an amended complaint, asking a judge to confirm their one-business-day listing rules are lawful.

Why it matters: Arizona Regional MLS, bridgeMLS, Canopy MLS, Doorify MLS, Hive MLS and REcolorado sued October 21 in the Southern District of New York. MLSListings, with about 16,000 subscribers, joined by an amended complaint filed October 30, after a September 8 Compass demand letter. They seek a declaration that rules requiring listings within one business day of public marketing comply with antitrust law, and an injunction against Compass suing over them. A separate suit by CRMLS and OneKey makes nine MLSs in two cases. Read your MLS's public-marketing rule before you market any office exclusive.

Inman: MLSListings joins Compass legal fight · HousingWire: MLSListings lawsuit vs. Compass · RISMedia Court Report, November 3, 2026

MONEY

A Pennsylvania homebuyer sued Keller Williams Elite in Lancaster County over a $650 broker fee he says had no service behind it, RISMedia reported November 3.

Why it matters: The suit alleges breach of fiduciary duty and a violation of Pennsylvania's consumer protection law. The buyer seeks $50,000 and a declaration barring the fee. These are allegations; the court has not ruled. A flat fee charged to a buyer is the exposure: the claim is that the fee bought no service. Pull every broker, transaction or admin fee your brokerage charges buyers and sellers, write down what service each one pays for, and check that each is on the disclosure the client signs before closing. Strike any fee you cannot tie to a named service.

RISMedia Court Report, November 3, 2026

THE BACKGROUND SIGNAL

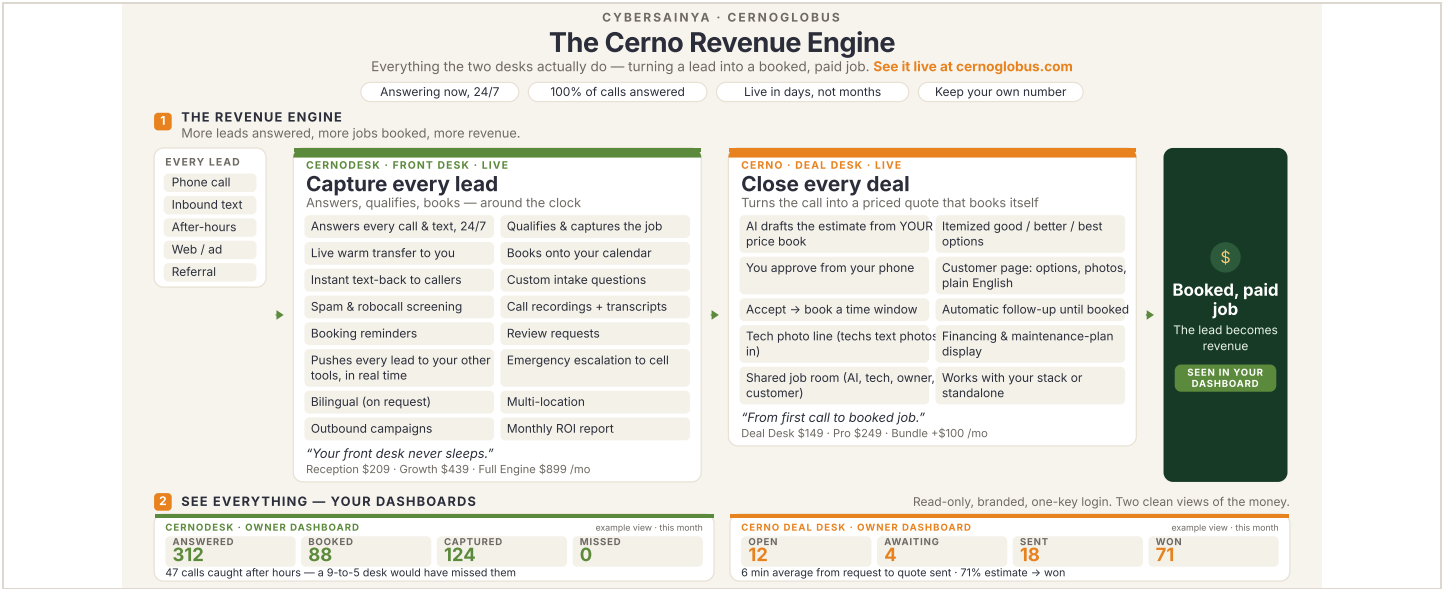
The fraud that reads your invoices before it sends one

The FBI's Internet Crime Complaint Center took 24,768 business email compromise reports in 2025, with losses of $3.05 billion — a record, after dipping to $2.77 billion in 2024 from $2.95 billion in 2023. Across all internet crime it logged 1,008,597 complaints and $20.88 billion in losses. Reported cases only, so read it as a floor.

Business email compromise, not ransomware, is the one that should concern a professional services firm. Someone gets into a mailbox, reads until they understand how you invoice and who pays you, then sends a real-looking progress billing with different bank details. No malware, no warning — just a payment that never arrives and an argument about who eats it. A firm that emails engagement letters, statements and vendor invoices all day is the shape this is built for. The quieter number is adoption: under 20% of firms with fewer than 20 staff use AI at all.

What to do about it: You don't need a security program. You need multi-factor authentication on email and your accounting login, and one rule everybody follows: nobody changes bank details on the strength of an email or a call — you ring the number you already had on file and confirm. That covers most of it, and costs nothing. The part it doesn't — how the systems are set up — is the day job of our parent company, CyberSainya.

FBI Internet Crime Complaint Center, 2025 Internet Crime Report — reported cases only, rounded from $2,946,830,270, $2,770,151,146 and $3,046,598,558. U.S. Census Bureau, Business Trends and Outlook Survey, May 3, 2026.



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